

worth more than \$750 000 did so for reasons that included helping their kids buy a home.

Breathe.

I believe giving your kids a handout—even if you can afford it—is more likely to *hinder* than help them long term.

Yet you still probably don't believe me.

So let me tell you about a kid I know who never got a handout . . . and it turned out to be the best thing that ever happened to him.

The luckiest man in the world

Peter greeted me like an old friend, even though we were meeting for the first time.

He was in his late 50s and wore jeans, runners, a white buttoned shirt and a warm smile.

Now read this carefully, because there's a lot that you and I can learn from Peter's story:

He attended the local public school.

He grew up in an average, unflashy suburban home that his father bought 60 years ago, and still lives in today.

His family drove sensible cars that they kept for many years.

And when he was growing up, his father paid him a small allowance that he was expected to work for.

Pretty ordinary stuff, right?

Well, sure.

Except that Peter's father is far from ordinary.

He's investment legend Warren Buffett, one of the wealthiest people on the planet (and the man I named my golden retriever after).